

Dylan Volantis, LHP, Texas

2026 Stats: 2.08 ERA /95 IP/1.000 WHIP/135 K/28 BB/4.82 K:BB

6-6, 220

Metrics

FB: 92/15 IVB/-7.4 HB/-5.91 VAA/6.99 relH/5.64 ext/39.1% zone/4.8% usage/2380 rpm

SI: 91.8/7.2 IVB/-13.4 HB/-7.57 VAA/6.79 relH/5.72 ext/38.3% zone/28.6% usage/2370 rpm

CB: 81.3/-11.3 IVB/3.2 HB/-10.11 VAA/28% zone/40.4% usage/2540 rpm

SL: 83.6/0.5 IVB/-1.6 HB/-8.40 VAA/38.5% zone/21.2% usage/2550 rpm

SPL: 83.5/6.1 IVB/-10 HB/-7.79 VAA/24.3% zone/4.9% usage/1130 rpm

Write-up

Volantis was one of the anchors of 'Texas' rotation in 2026, combining durability with one of the deepest breaking-ball arsenals in the country. Rather than relying on overpowering velocity, he attacks hitters through sequencing, movement diversity, and exceptional feel for his curveball. The profile is unconventional by today's standards, using the four-seam fastball almost exclusively as a show-me offering while leaning heavily on a sinker, curveball, and slider to generate weak contact and swing-and-miss. The result was one of the best statistical seasons in college baseball, highlighted by 135 strikeouts across 95 innings while maintaining a 2.08 ERA. The profile projects as a professional starter because of the four-pitch mix and strike-throwing ability, though continued refinement of the fastball usage will determine just how high the ceiling ultimately climbs.

The SI serves as the primary fastball and is the foundation of the repertoire. Sitting around 92 mph with heavy depth and strong arm-side movement approaching 13.5 inches, it consistently runs beneath barrels while generating uncomfortable contact. Volantis shows confidence throwing it to both sides of the plate, but it is especially effective running away from right-handed hitters before expanding below the zone. While the swing-and-miss numbers are only solid, the sinker's primary value lies in setting up the breaking balls and forcing hitters to respect the lower half of the strike zone. Further, its contact quality was elite, allowing a 71% GB rate and -7.9 average launch angle. Even the hard hits were on the

ground to a 65% GB rate. Improving his ability to consistently work to the edges rather than catching too much of the plate would help the pitch play up even further. 50/55 pitch

The CB is the best pitch in the arsenal and one of the premier breaking balls in the 2027 class. Sitting around 81 mph with elite depth, outstanding spin, and a steep approach angle, the pitch simply overwhelms hitters. Its death ball shape from his incredibly funky high release creates an incredibly uncomfortable look for hitters. It accounted for the overwhelming majority of his swing-and-miss production, including over 100 whiffs against right-handed hitters alone, and consistently finished at-bats when buried beneath the strike zone. The shape allows him to both land it early for strikes and expand late without hitters picking it up. Even when hitters recognized the pitch, they frequently struggled to square it up because of the late vertical finish. This is a legitimate professional out pitch capable of missing bats at every level. 65/70 pitch

The SL provides an entirely different breaking-ball look and complements the curveball exceptionally well. Rather than featuring massive sweep, the slider is tighter with shorter lateral movement and late downward bite, allowing it to bridge the gap between the sinker and curveball. Volantis uses it primarily against right-handed hitters as another chase option beneath the zone, where it consistently generates empty swings despite more modest usage. The ability to throw two distinctly different breaking balls keeps hitters from sitting on one movement profile and gives him multiple avenues to finish at-bats. It projects comfortably as an above-average secondary. 55/60 pitch

The SPL is used sparingly but flashes intriguing traits. With late tumble and excellent separation off the sinker, it provides another weapon against left-handed hitters while giving the repertoire additional vertical diversity. Although the usage remains limited, the movement profile suggests there is room for the pitch to become a larger part of his attack as he continues developing. Increasing confidence in the splitter would further reduce hitters' ability to key on the breaking balls in two-strike counts. 45/50 pitch

The FB is more of a wrinkle rather than a featured offering. With only a handful of uses throughout the season, it functions primarily as an occasional change of eye level above the zone rather than a pitch he consistently attacks with. The movement profile is adequate, but the sinker is simply a better fit for

the rest of his arsenal and the angle he creates with his unique windup. Unless the four-seam usage expands, it is unlikely to play a significant role in his professional profile. 40/45 pitch